TASK 5: CYBERCRIME AWARENESS CASE STUDY & PREVENTION GUIDE

PART B: PREVENTION CHECKLIST:

While researching cyber safety, what surprised me the most was how common and sophisticated online scams have become, especially among students and young users. I discovered that many cybercrimes in India involve simple tactics such as phishing links, fake job offers, and fraudulent calls pretending to be from banks or customer care services. What was particularly alarming is how easily people can be tricked into sharing sensitive information like OTPs or approving fake payment requests. The rise of UPI-based frauds has made digital transactions more vulnerable if users are not careful. It was surprising to learn that even a small mistake, such as clicking on an unknown link or not verifying a payment request, can lead to significant financial loss within seconds.

This research made me more aware of my own online behavior and the risks involved in everyday digital activities. One important habit I will personally change is being more cautious and alert while making online payments or responding to unknown messages and calls. I will make it a point to always verify the identity of the sender, double-check UPI details before transferring money, and never share confidential information under any circumstances. Additionally, I will avoid using unsecured public Wi-Fi for sensitive transactions and ensure my accounts are protected with strong passwords and two-factor authentication. Adopting these habits will help me stay safe online and become a more responsible digital user.